

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 864

By Lynn

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Roshanda Dana Heath Walker.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the untimely passing of Roshanda Dana Heath Walker, formerly of Mt. Juliet; and

WHEREAS, Roshanda Walker was an accomplished attorney and a true intellectual leader admired for her resilience, humor, and generosity; she approached life with intention and heart, always striving to uplift others through her wisdom, compassion, and unwavering love; and

WHEREAS, born in Miami, Florida, on July 27, 1979, Mrs. Walker was raised in Mt. Juliet and educated in the Wilson County School System; she went on to earn her Bachelor of Arts degree in Political Science, *magna cum laude*, from Howard University in 2001 and her Juris Doctor degree from Thomas M. Cooley Law School in 2006; and

WHEREAS, early in her career, Roshanda Walker served as an attorney with the Dallas County District Attorney's Office, gaining invaluable experience in public prosecution; her professional journey combined strong academic credentials, public-sector prosecutorial work, and private-sector litigation and defense, giving her a broad and balanced perspective on the Texas legal system; and

WHEREAS, she practiced law with integrity, fairness, and empathy, earning the admiration of colleagues and the trust of those she represented; and

WHEREAS, in addition to her service as a member of the bar, she dedicated herself to community service through active membership in Delta Sigma Theta Sorority, Inc., and Jack and Jill of America, Inc.; her light and love transformed lives, inspiring joy and connection wherever she went; and

WHEREAS, introduced to Christ at an early age, Mrs. Walker was baptized as a child and nurtured a lifelong journey of faith that she enjoyed with her family; and

WHEREAS, Roshanda Walker was deeply devoted to her family, and she always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Walker is lovingly remembered by her dear husband of twenty years, Jason Walker; her children, Braylon Walker and Bailey Walker; her loving and very devoted parents, Reverend James Tibbs and First Lady Doris Tibbs; her grandmother, Vera Heath; and her sister, Michelle Malone; and

WHEREAS, she is further survived by her mother-in-law, Emma Walker; her father-in-law, Gary (Brenda) Walker; her sisters-in-law, Robin and Asylin; her brothers-in-law, Garrick, Pierce, and Elliott; her aunts, Effie Hayes, Georgia Cain, Minnie (Vester) McFarland, and Barbara (Michael) Riley; her uncle, Bruce Tibbs; her father, Anthony Weatherford; and a host of extended brothers, sisters, aunts, uncles, nieces, nephews, cousins, and devoted friends; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Walker was preceded in death by her mother, Theresa Heath; her brother, Larry Overall; and her grandparents, Macie and Jimmie Tibbs, Charles Smith, and Teresa Strowther; and

WHEREAS, Roshanda Walker leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all her chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Roshanda Dana Heath Walker, reflecting fondly

upon her impeccable character and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mrs. Walker.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.